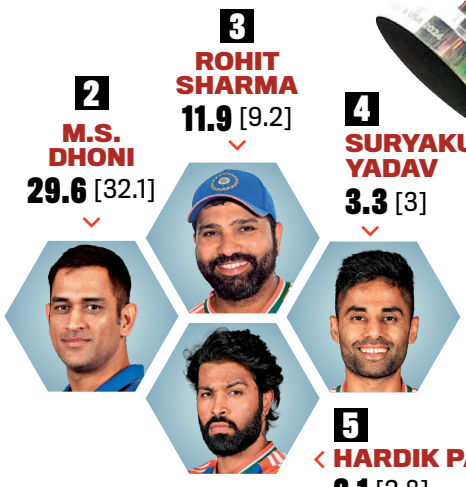




2 M.S. DHONI **29.6** [32.1]

3 ROHIT SHARMA **11.9** [9.2]

4 SURYAKUMAR YADAV **3.3** [3]

5 HARDIK PANDYA **3.1** [2.8]



ANI

1 VIRAT KOHLI **39.3** [41.4]

Q. Who is India's No. 1 male cricketer?

SOME NEW SHOTS

World Cup winning heroes take over cricket, as Neeraj and Sindhu hold on to their No. 1 crowns. But Manu, Vinesh and Lakshya are new favourites

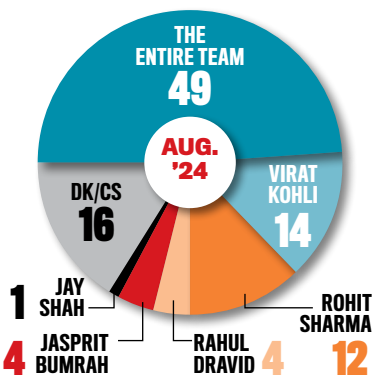
All figures in %; rest, others & don't know/ can't say (DK/ CS); Aug. '24 figures in bold, Feb. '24 in [ ]

By SUHANI SINGH

Indians following sports had a rocky ride in the last six months. Until early July the nation was on cloud nine, with the Men in Blue winning its second Twenty-20 World Cup title. Four heroes from that unbeaten side made it to the India Today Mood of the Nation ranking of top five male cricketers—Virat Kohli, Rohit Sharma, Suryakumar Yadav and Hardik Pandya. The exception is M.S. Dhoni, whose aura remains undiminished. For 49 per cent MOTN respondents, WC glory wasn't a one-man show but a team effort. The same five women cricketers feature in the top five this time as in February, with Smriti Mandhana and Harmanpreet Kaur leading the charge, and the retired, but ever-popular, Mithali Raj dropping to No. 4.

A month after the triumph in the Caribbean, euphoria made way for despair as enthusiasts tuned into the Paris Olympic Games to see India come agonisingly close to medals, only to falter in crunch situations and being denied by the narrowest of margins—one point (in shooting and archery), one bout (in boxing), one kilo (in weightlifting) and one hundred grams (Vinesh Phogat's weigh-in). Add to that Lakshya Sen's missing a badminton medal by a whisker. It wasn't all gloom though. The most uplifting story from Paris was that of shooter Manu Bhaker, who made it to the finals of all three events she participated in and returned with two bronze medals. The MOTN ranking for non-cricket sportswomen is again headed by P.V. Sindhu, followed by new entrants Manu and Vinesh, who became India's first female wrestler to make it to the finals, only to be denied a silver in a cruel twist of fate. Her strong showing in the poll indicates how she won the hearts of many.

Q. Who should be credited the most for India's victory in the ICC T20 World Cup 2024?



Respondents appreciated all contributions towards winning the T20 World Cup

All figures in % and rounded off